

SHIELD

Mauna Loa, Hawaii, USA

Shield volcanoes have gently sloping sides and are formed from thin, runny lava. Their eruptions are less explosive and much less dangerous than other volcanoes. These gentle eruptions can continue for years.



CINDER CONE

Paricutin, Mexico

Cinder cone volcanoes are the smallest and most common type of volcano. They are cone-shaped with steep sides. Their eruptions are usually not too violent.



CALDERA

Ngorongoro, Tanzania

Calderas are large, circular hollows, almost like a bowl. They form when a massive eruption forces most of the magma out of the chamber under the volcano, causing it to collapse.